

Sultant Of Oman
Ministry of Health
Royal Hospital



سلطنة عمان
وزارة الصحة
المستشفى السلطاني

Document Management System



Sultanate of Oman
Ministry of Health
The Royal Hospital
Department of Pharmacy

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Title: Management of High Potency Narcotics in Patient Care Areas

Purpose

To provide a standard processes for the labeling and storage of narcotics in patient care areas in order to minimize risk and prevent patient harm as part of the Royal

Hospital management of high alert medication(HAM) strategy. The supply, prescribing, dispensing, and administration of narcotics is excluded from this policy.

Policy Statement

The Royal Hospital will evaluate and limit the availability, as feasible, of high potency narcotic products in patient care areas in order to minimize and prevent patient harm.

Applicability

This policy and procedure applies to all Royal Hospital staff, members of the medical team,including physicians, nurses, pharmacists, pharmacy technicians and other persons working in the Royal Hospital.

Responsibility

Royal Hospital managers will demonstrate commitment to safety of all patients by ensuring that maximal safeguards are in place for high potency narcotics when stocked in patient care areas.

The **Narcotic and psychotropic** in-charge at the Royal Hospital will demonstrate commitment to safety of all patients by ensuring that processes are in place to identify, store,supply, and label narcotics in accordance to

Principles

The **Narcotic and Psychotropic In-charge** and **ward managers** will evaluate and audit bi-annually to limit the availability of narcotic products where feasible, and ensure maximal safeguards are in place to minimize any potential harm caused by high potency narcotic products.

Procedures

In the Medical Stores:

- Narcotics will be stored in dedicated areas as per the narcotic policy. The necessary auxiliary and cautionary labels must be visible and in place.

In patient care areas:

- All narcotics must be stored in accordance to the narcotic policy, within a designated area, in a locked cabinet, with the appropriate log book.
- In **all pediatric wards**, **morphine 10mg/mL** must be stored in a locked cabinet with a log book in place, and a visible **high potency** and a high alert medication label in the allocated storage cabinet must be present. It must be separated from other morphine strengths if available.
- Fentanyl 500mcg/10 mL must be stored in a locked cabinet with a log book in place, and a visible **high potency** and a high alert medication label in the allocated storage cabinet must be present. It must be separated from other fentanyl strengths if available.
- All necessary auxiliary and cautionary labels must be visible and in place.
- If more than one strength of the same narcotic medication is stocked in patient care areas, they must be segregated from each other in the storage cabinets.

Dispensing

Narcotic medication (injections and tablet) are available in the ward as stock item and indent is made according to weekly timetable

Administering

Infusion or syringe pumps will be used to administer infusions of narcotic medications. Smart pumps with error reduction software should be utilized if available.

Independent double check will be completed as per the independent double check policy.

References

Title of book/ journal/ articles/ Website	Author	Year of publication	Page
Alberta Health Services Management of High-alert Medications: High-Alert Medications : High-Potency Narcotics, Guideline. 2014.	Accreditation Canada QMentum Program, Medication Management Standards	2016	28

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